THREAT DETECTION DOSSIER / 13 OCTOBER 2026

MATCHBOIL
FILE ARTIFACT HUNT

Campaign-specific endpoint hunting for source-observed payload and configuration artifacts.

HUNTING | CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM | DEFENDER XDR

Primary research: ESET Research, published 8 October 2026
Observed samples: April 2024-April 2026; telemetry sightings through June 2026
Implementation status: Untested implementation sketch

Executive assessment

7/10

Operational value for retrospective scope and sample collection.

Campaign-specific artifact

Mutable paths and filenames prevent durable production detection.

What the source establishes

- MATCHBOIL is a C# downloader used by UAC-0099 to retrieve, install, and persist another payload.
- ESET observed WallpappersSet.jpg in a user Pictures directory, config.library-ms in C:\Users\Public\Libraries, and SMTPClientApplication.exe under %LOCALAPPDATA%\SMTPClient.
- Variants used Run keys or scheduled tasks, but the public source does not establish a consistent endpoint event schema for those writes.

A match is evidence of an artifact occurrence only. It does not prove execution, persistence, C2, compromise, or attribution.

Observed attack flow

1. Delivery

Archive and VBScript

2. Execution

User runs script

3. Discovery

CPUID and BIOS data

4. C2

Three HTTPS requests

5. Installation

Payload and config files

6. Persistence

Run key or task

7. Evasion

Uptime/debugger checks

Detection boundary

Public evidence supports exact destination filename and folder matching. It does not support reconstructing encrypted response bodies, asserting task creation from process telemetry, or treating campaign domains as durable behavior.

Direct ATT&CK mapping

T1036.005 - Match Legitimate Resource Name or Location. SMTPClientApplication.exe and its placement were used to make the installed payload less conspicuous.

Telemetry and schema

Raw telemetry	Microsoft Defender for Endpoint file activity	Required
Table	DeviceFileEvents	Documented
Timestamp / DeviceId / DeviceName	Time and device correlation	Documented
FileName / FolderPath	Primary artifact match	Documented
ActionType / SHA1	Investigation context	Event-dependent
InitiatingProcess*	Optional enrichment	Event-dependent

Detection hypothesis

If an attacker deploys the source-observed MATCHBOIL artifacts, endpoint file telemetry should show the documented filename-folder combinations. Distinguish them using exact path pairing, prevalence, hash reputation, process provenance, and software ownership.

Unavailable from this hunt

File content, successful execution, scheduled-task or Run-key state, HTTPS response body, decoder behavior, and actor identity are not inferred.

Primary hunting query

```
DeviceFileEvents
| where
    (FileName == "SMTPClientApplication.exe"
        and FolderPath endswith @"\AppData\Local\SMTPClient")
    or (FileName == "config.library-ms"
        and FolderPath == @"C:\Users\Public\Libraries")
    or (FileName == "WallpappersSet.jpg"
        and FolderPath endswith @"\Pictures")
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, ActionType,
          FileName, FolderPath, SHA1,
          InitiatingProcessFileName,
          InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
          InitiatingProcessAccountName
| order by Timestamp desc
```

Condition evidence

Every filename-folder pair is directly documented by ESET. No hash, domain, rarity score, count, join, sequence, or arbitrary time window is introduced.

Status

Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch. Confidence Medium because the fields are documented while event completeness and benign overlap still require environment validation.

Triage and false positives

Investigate every match

- Inspect SHA1 prevalence and reputation.
- Review initiating process, signer, origin URL, and adjacent process events.
- Check authoritative task telemetry for UpdateCheckers\DailyPlanner or MailClient\Checker.
- Review network activity from the same DeviceId around the event.

Potential benign overlap

- Legitimate SMTP client utilities.
- User-created images with the misspelled filename.
- Legitimate Windows Library description files.
- Software installers reusing generic names.

Tuning and failure conditions

Do not globally allowlist a filename. Allowlist only verified signer-hash-path combinations or managed deployment evidence. The hunt fails when MDE omits the event, retention excludes activity, the actor changes artifacts, or paths are normalized unexpectedly.

Validation plan

1	**Create inert files in the three documented locations.**	Exact FileName and FolderPath appear.
2	**Run across the longest supported retention.**	Raw events include device and process context.
3	**Measure prevalence and identify software owners.**	Results are absent or narrowly reviewable.
4	**Pivot test events to process and network data.**	DeviceId and timestamps correlate reliably.

Secondary platforms

Splunk: No reliable implementation can currently be written without a verified endpoint source, sourcetype, and field extraction.

Chronicle: No reliable implementation can currently be written without a verified parser and UDM mapping for file path, device, and initiating process.

References and analyst notes

Primary research

ESET Research, MATCHBOIL: New tricks, same old evil intentions, published 8 October 2026. Samples April 2024-April 2026; telemetry sightings through June 2026.
hxxps://www[.]welivesecurity[.]com/en/eset-research/matchboil-new-tricks-same-old-evil-intentions/

Official schema

Microsoft, DeviceFileEvents table in the advanced hunting schema, updated 22 June 2026.
hxxps://learn[.]microsoft[.]com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-devicefileevents-table

ATT&CK

T1036.005 - Masquerading: Match Legitimate Resource Name or Location.
hxxps://attack[.]mitre[.]org/techniques/T1036/005/

Analyst conclusion: useful retrospective artifact hunt; not a durable malware-family detector and not suitable for alerting without environment validation.

No customer data. Public-source artifacts only. URLs defanged.